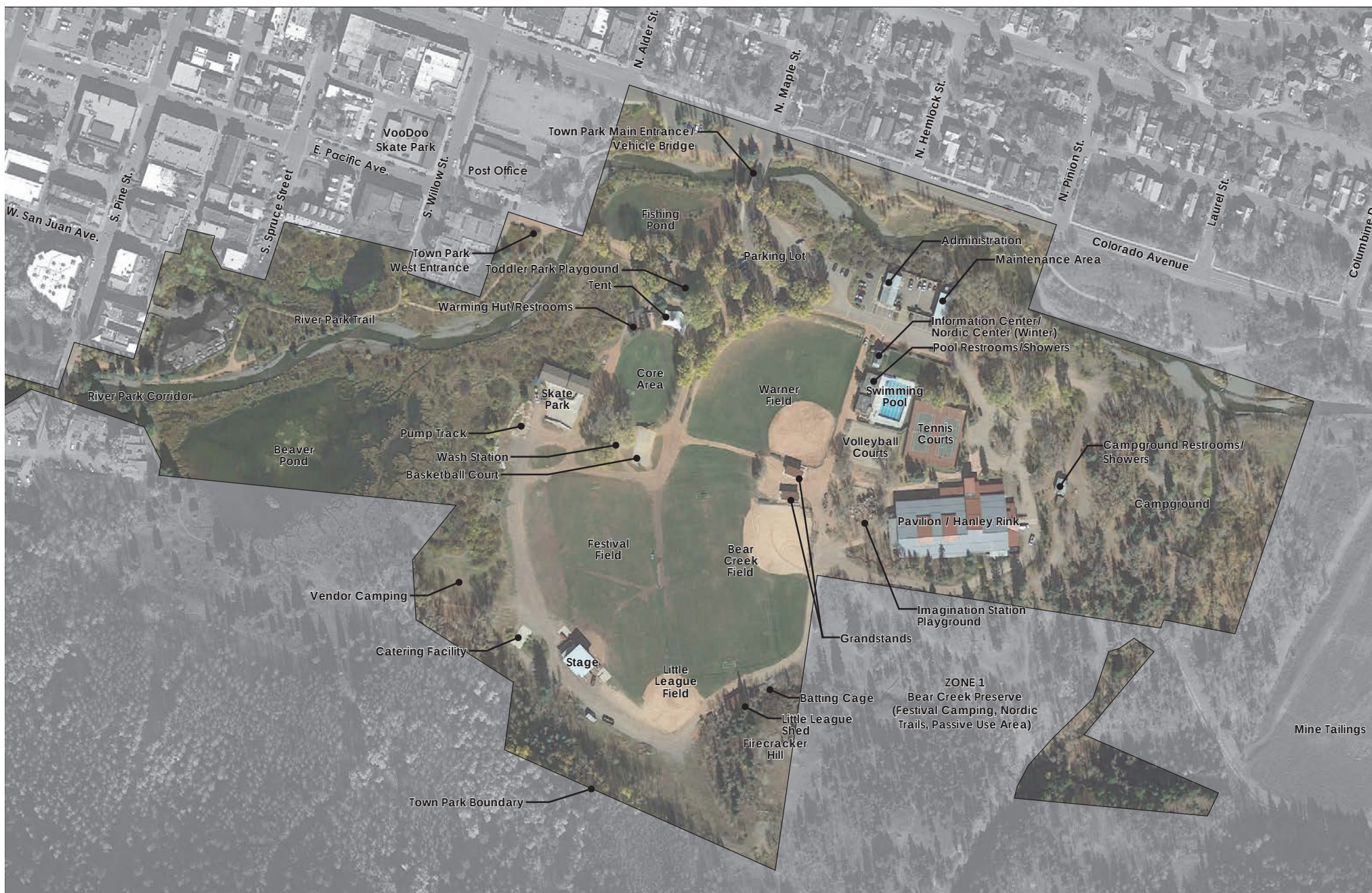




Current Uses and Demands

During the winter months, park use is prevalent at the following facilities:

- a beginner to intermediate Nordic track and Nordic Center.
- the Pavilion / Hanley Ice Rink, where there is heavy demand for ice time from adult and youth hockey leagues as well as figure skating and curling clubs.
- Outdoor ice rink.
- Sledding hill.

To a much lesser extent there is demand on the River Trail, which serves as a pedestrian corridor across Town. The Colorado Avenue pocket parks receive little to no use during the winter and serve as snow storage areas. In the shoulder seasons in the fall and spring, the Pavilion supports team sports including soccer and lacrosse to help practices start during times when play outside is still limited due to snow, cold temperatures, or uncertain weather.

During summer months, the pattern of use and demand shift significantly. Town Park becomes the centerpiece of the community, accommodating a variety of recreational programs as well as special event uses. From late May through mid-September, Town Park sees three (3) major festivals, several smaller special events, large community celebrations including the 4th of July, and several major athletic programs and tournaments.

Likewise, the River Park Corridor and Trail as well as the Colorado Ave pocket parks also receive greater frequency of use. The River Park Corridor and Trail serves as an important mobility system east to west across Town linking the downtown to the Town Park. The Colorado Avenue pocket parks support special events and festivals beyond everyday use, including pedestrian activity in the downtown core.

Year-round demand and need for a dedicated space for youth was repeatedly expressed by the community during the planning process. With the slated development of the Youth Link skate park and the elimination of the 'Voodoo Lounge' there is no longer a designated place for youth to congregate near downtown. Representatives of Tri-County Health and high school students engaged in the process and articulated these needs on behalf of the youth.

Competing Recreation and Special Events Uses

As the Telluride community has grown and the popularity of special events has also grown over the past 15 years, increasingly there are competing uses for the available park space. Major festivals have long held a place and are part of the special events tradition in Telluride, serving as major economic drivers for the Town and region. Major festivals include three (3) multi-day extended weekends throughout the summer including the Telluride Bluegrass Festival on the third weekend in June, the Ride Festival on the second weekend in July after Independence Day, and the Blues and Brews Festival on the third weekend in September. These festivals include use of the majority of Town Park, the Campground, and Zone 1 of the Bear Creek Open Space for camping for a limited number of festival ticket holders.

Sports and athletic tournaments are also popular and softball and soccer leagues hold daily games and annual summer tournaments in Town Park. The latter are being increasingly constrained due to special events. Furthermore, recreational facilities in the park are impacted by major festivals, in some cases restricting or preventing access of park facilities by everyday park users. Facilities with restricted public use during festivals currently include: the main skate park, Warming Hut, and basketball court. While the pool, volleyball courts, tennis courts, and Imagination Station playground are left open to the public, access is limited, controlled, and difficult, becoming impractical for many locals, especially those with small children.

Anticipated Future Trends

The planning process for the TPMPU resulted in community feedback expressing greater need and demand for recreational facilities and uses in Town Park. The community clearly expressed a desire for renovating and expanding recreational facilities that will increase the level of use of park facilities across the seasons. There is interest in additional sheets of ice to support hockey, curling, and figure skating, a new skate park to replace the Youth Link, and improvements to the Core Area that will support greater multi-uses. There are emerging sports such as pickle ball, stand-up paddling, and river tubing that are causing greater interest and use of Town parks properties. Use of electric assisted bicycles (e-bikes) is on the rise and there is an increase of e-bike traffic on the River Trail and throughout the Town.

As a result of these anticipated future trends, the direction of the TPMPU is to provide greater and more multi-use recreation facilities in Town Park over the next 15 years. In consideration of the important role of major festival and special events, additional circulation, staging, infrastructure, and improvements are also included in the plan and coordinated carefully with new or renovated recreation facilities. As new recreational facilities are renovated and developed, the ability to access and use the facilities during special events becomes a key planning and design determinant.